

Figure 1: Downloading Chatterbean



Figure 2: Extracting Chatterbean to the folder

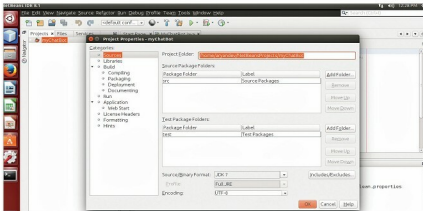


Figure 3: Creating a project and copying its path



Figure 4: Copying botoflife to NetbeansProject/mychatbot/src

Steps to creating a chat robot

1. Download the source code from <http://www.alicebot.org/downloads/programs.html>
2. Go to the Java section.
3. Download the source code under the link *Chatterbean*.
4. Under the section 'Download, Building and Usage Information', go to 'Download Chatterbean 0.00.008 Source Distribution'. We will download the source code rather than the binary distribution.
5. Extract Chatterbean to the folder (Figure 2).

This extracted folder contains the 'Bot' directory, which will have the collection of AIML. We can create our own AIML to increase the knowledge of our robot. But first let's proceed to the set-up. The folder 'Source' contains Java code for the robot A.L.I.C.E and the AIML parser. We will use this, as it is, in our program.

Preparing NetBeans for coding

The following steps prepare NetBeans for coding.

1. Create a project named 'myChatBot'.
2. Copy the existing source code of A.L.I.C.E into our *Project* folder. Copy *botoflife* from the downloaded source code to *NetbeansProject/mychatbot/src* as shown in Figure 4.

The source code will appear in the *Projects* tab, under *Source Packages* at the NetBeans IDE shown in Figure 5.

3. Now copy the Bot folder from the downloaded source code to *NetbeansProject/myChatBot* as shown in Figure 6.
4. Add additional supportive libraries which come with the A.L.I.C.E source code. These are *bsh.jar* and *junit.jar*. The set-up is now ready. Open *MyChatBot.java* which contains *main()* and import the libraries, using